ethOS INTelligence

Law Enforcement Online Privacy Checklist

Easy accessibility to your sensitive, identifying data provides hackers and undesirable online predators with the opportunity to obtain your personal information, which can be broadcast on media platforms in a practice commonly referred to as "Doxing". **Doxing,** the act of publicly revealing previously private personal information about an individual or organization, is most often conducted with malicious intent. First emerging in the 1990's when anonymity was considered more sacred, doxing practices have increased recently across the US. Doxing may lead to threatening actions, such as intimidation, harassment, and the stalking of a victim and his or her family.

Use the checklist below to minimize your online privacy risk and personal data exposure.

People-Search Website Data Removal

Sensitive personal information can populate within seconds after conducting a simple Google search. It is important to take proactive steps to remove your personal information from the Internet, such as your name, date of birth, phone number, email, home address, and information about your family members.

☐ Begin by searching for yourself online, Google your name and the city you reside in using quotations, for example – "name" "city". Make a list of your sensitive, private information that appears on the first few pages of your Google results.

☐ Create a temporary "burner" email address to use for removals. We do not recommend using your personal email address for removals (Protonmail.com is recommended).

Opt out/remove your information from the following people-search data websites listed below. These sites are some of the larger, more popular ones. Removal of these sites will trickle down to many of the smaller sites. Once completed, wait a week before you Google your name again. If your information is still appearing in the results, submit removals for those, as well.

To complete removals, you will need to visit each site individually. First, search for your name and location. If your information is found, access the removal link, and follow the "opt out" instructions. Most sites will automatically send a confirmation email that requires steps to confirm your removal. If your information is not found, proceed to the next site, beginning the process again.

☐ **Spokeo** -
Website: https://spokeo.com - Removal Link: https://www.spokeo.com/optout
Contact: support@spokeo.com, customercare@spokeo.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Mylife** –
Website: https://www.mylife.com - Removal Link: https://www.mylife.com/ccpa/index.pubview
Contact: privacy@mylife.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Fast People Search** -
Website: https://fastpeoplesearch.com – Removal Link: https://www.fastpeoplesearch.com/removal

Contact: https://www.fastpeoplesearch.com/contact
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Radaris** –
Website: https://radaris.com - Removal Link: https://radaris.com/control/privacy
Contact: support@radaris.com, info@radaris.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Nuwber** –
Website: https://www.nuwber.com - Removal Link: https://nuwber.com/removal/link
Contact: support@nuwber.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **That's Them** –
Website: https://thatsthem.com - Removal Link: https://thatsthem.com/optout
Contact: https://thatsthem.com/contact
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Truth Finder** –
Website: https://www.truthfinder.com - Removal Link: https://www.truthfinder.com/opt-out/
Contact: support@truthfinder.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **White Pages** –
Website: https://whitepages.com - Removal Link: http://www.whitepages.com/suppression_requests
Contact: support@whitepages.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Been Verified –**
Website: https://www.beenverified.com - Removal Link: https://www.beenverified.com/faq/opt-out/
Contact: privacy@beenverified.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Acxiom** – *Go directly to removal link and submit removal information
Website: https://www.acxiom.com - Removal Link: https://isapps.acxiom.com/optout/optout.aspx
Contact: consumeradvo@acxiom.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Infotracer** –
Website: https://infotracer.com - Removal Link: https://infotracer.com/optout

Contact: https://infotracer.com/help/
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **InstantCheckMate –**
Website: http://www.instantcheckmate.com – Removal Link: http://www.instantcheckmate.com/optout
Contact: privacy@instantcheckmate.com, support@instantcheckmate.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Intelius –**
Web Site: http://www.intelius.com – Removal Link: https://www.intelius.com/optout
Contact: privacy@intelius.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **Lexis Nexis** – *Go directly to removal link and submit removal information
Website: https://lexisnexis.com - Removal Link: https://optout.lexisnexis.com
Contact: privacy.information.mgr@lexisnexis.com
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

☐ **TruePeopleSearch** –
Website: https://www.truepeoplesearch.com - Removal
Link: https://www.truepeoplesearch.com/removal
Contact: https://www.truepeoplesearch.com/contact
Link/URL:
Submission Date:
Removal Date:

Data removal is recommended for EVERY adult member living in your household.

As time elapses, your personal information may repopulate on the sites listed above. We recommend that your review the removal process every six months.

Use **Outdated Google Removal Tool** if a People-Search Website has removed your information but your information is still appearing in Google search results.

Social Media Privacy

Assume everything posted to social media will eventually become public.

Social media is one of the first places that people utilize to find information about you, whether the intentions are positive or malicious.

Make sure all personal accounts are set to private and passwords are updated regularly. Avoid using common passwords such as the names of family members, dates of birth or anniversaries, pet names, or any other information that can be easily predicted. Longer, complex passwords are usually more secure.

Turn ON multi-factor authentication (MFA or sometimes referred to as two-factor authentication) whenever possible. According to Google, multi-factor authentication through SMS text messages—can stop 100% of all automated attacks, 96% of bulk phishing attacks, and three-quarters of targeted attacks.

Use different usernames across social media platforms. Many people use the same username across a wide variety of services which allows potential doxers to build a profile of the target's interests and how they spend their time on the Internet.

Facebook –

☐ **How People Find and Contact You** - To help prevent the accessibility of your Facebook page by undesired visitors, update your personal preferences in the privacy section for "How people find and contact you". To ensure your safety online, it is important to select "No" for "Do you want search engines outside of Facebook to link to your profile?"

☐ **Timeline and Tagging** - Under Profile and Tagging, review all content that has been tagged. Option one allows you to approve or dismiss posts that you are tagged in before they appear on your Timeline and option two allows you to approve or dismiss tags people have added to your posts. Once this is activated, you will be required to approve any tagged posts prior to them appearing on your timeline.

☐ **Location sharing** - Avoid checking into nearby locations or adding your location to a post. Review all tagged posts to ensure that your location has not been shared.

☐ **Review your profile** – Under profile and tagging at the bottom of the page, use "view as" to see what information the public can access about you

Whenever you share status updates and photos, or create informational posts on Facebook, you are able to utilize the **Audience Selector Tool** to control the audience that is able to view what you circulate. This tool allows you to decide who has access to your shared information. Using the custom option, you can be highly specific for who is able and unable to view your posts.

Instagram –

☐ **Set to private** – Ensure your Instagram account is set to private. Instagram notes that once your profile is set to private, new followers will have to send a follow request to see your images. However, posts you share to other social media networks may be visible depending on the preference lists for each specific network.

☐ **Tagging Settings** - Ensure Manually Approve Tags is ON

Twitter –

☐ **Discoverability** - Anyone who has access to your email address or phone number is able to search for you on Twitter using this information. In addition, anyone who stores this information in their contact list will be provided with your account information once they join Twitter. To turn this function off, visit your privacy settings and under Discoverability, uncheck "Let others find you by your email" and/or "Let others find you by your phone".

☐ **Tweet location** - Ensure that this option has not been activated.

Contact any friends or connections that post personal information that you prefer to maintain as a private and ask them to delete it.

LinkedIn –

☐ **Profile Photo** - You can suppress your profile photo from standard public display and only to confirmed professionals.

☐ **LinkedIn Name** - Hide your last name from people not connected to your account. You can also modify your account's custom URL on your LinkedIn Profile to omit your full name.

☐ **Resume** - Openly posting your resume online is not recommended.

Additional Social Media Tips

If you are ever unsure before you share, post or tweet, we recommend you ask yourself the following questions:

- *Who am I sharing this information with?*
- *How much and what type of information am I sharing?*
- *How many people can view the information I am sharing?*
- *Can I trust every person that views this information?*

Face Shots and Real Name

Consider replacing profile photographs that clearly display your facial features with something more ambiguous because they are most often publicly accessible. Use an alternative name that doesn't include your complete real name. Do not forget to change any custom URL links that provide your real name, as well.

Minimize Risk of Exposure

Be cautious about over sharing details about your family's life and routines**.** Examples include information about your work shifts, family vacations, the names of the schools you or your children attend, or any other time or location sensitive information that easily communicates the dates and times of when and where you will or will not be in specific locations.

Do not display any personally identifiable information about yourself or your family on social media profile accounts. Your full name and the general vicinity of your home are sufficient identifying information for an undesirable predator to use against you.

Vacation and Away

When you post on social media that you are going on vacation or away from your home, you are setting your unoccupied house up to be an easy target. Refrain from sharing vacation pictures until you have returned home.

Ignore the Bullies

Resist the urge to type in anger. Do not reply to a comment or post that is upsetting. This will just fuel the fire for the bully and present an opportunity to set an evident target on your family's back.

Children's Information

Be cautious about including your child's name in photo tags or captions. If someone else includes it, delete the tag by clicking on the Remove Tag option. If someone includes your child's name in a caption, ask that person to remove it. Do not over share the details of your child's life online, such as sports practices, school activities, and

other events that likely occur on a predictable schedule. This will help decrease the possibility for your child to be easily tracked by unsolicited profile viewers or online predators.

Children's Social Media Accounts

Get in the habit of following your child's online activity and the social media platforms they are utilizing. Consider using a monitoring app such as Bark, Safer Kid, or Web Watcher to see your children's social media presence and activity. Discuss the importance of online privacy with your children and teach them to notify you if they encounter suspicious activity on their accounts.

Additional Privacy Tasks

Law Enforcement Address Confidentiality Form

Law enforcement officers, as defined in Chapter 58, Title 19, Idaho Code are entitled to keep their home address confidential with any public entity in Idaho. Examples include but are not limited to, voter registration, Department of Motor Vehicles, Assessors, Recorders, Public Schools, Fish and Game etc.

Contact your department to obtain the confidentiality form and receive signature from head of agency or his/her designee signer.

If you currently have any businesses with the Secretary of State's office, you will need to file a request or change the address on your paperwork with them.

Real Estate and Curbside Pictures

Real estate pictures online often show your home on a room-by-room basis. This may provide an intruder with details about the layout of your home and where you and your children sleep at night. Visit each listing site that displays the interior of your home and request removal. Also, consider suppressing curbside images of your home from Google Street View and Bing Streetside View.

Real Estate -
- ☐ Zillow
- ☐ Trulia
- ☐ Realtor
- ☐ Redfin
- ☐ Movoto
- ☐ Homesnap

Curbside -
- ☐ Google Street View
- ☐ Bing Streetside View

Set Up Google Alerts

- ☐ Go to www.google.com/alerts and create a Google alert of your name or any other information that you request to monitor is being shared online. This will help you track and request removals as soon as the information populates.

Home Address

☐ Consider having your mail sent to a Post Office Box.

If you have a business, avoid using your personal address as your business address.

Avoid putting your name, phone number, or personal information of any form or application without learning what the company's policy is. If you are not legally bound to enter personally identifiable information, then do not offer it.

Do not use your own name for any magazine subscriptions, mailers, value cards, coupons, or promotional giveaways. Do not fill out and return any warranty cards. This information is resold to marketing houses, which sell to public record database companies.

Avoid using personal addresses for campaign contributions as the donor information is publicly available and easily accessible online.

Disinformation Name

☐ Create a disinformation name to use for your home. Use this name when ordering magazines, food, groceries, items being delivered to your home and signing up for loyalty cards.

Disinformation is incorrect information associated with your real information. The purpose of using disinformation is to obscure accurate information that can be found on the Internet.

NEVER use disinformation or false details on any legally binding documents.

Talk To Your Inner Circle

Make a list of people that are close to you and share with them your privacy needs and desires. Raise the level of awareness with your loved ones and educate them on the best practices covered in this checklist. If a predator or stalker is unable to find you, they will most likely search for the people that are close to you.

☐ Immediate family
☐ Roommates/other household members
☐ Children, siblings, and parents with separate residences
☐ Close friends (especially those that are active on social media)
☐ Co-workers and colleagues (especially those that are active on social media)
☐ Any other groups that you are associated with

Ethos Intelligence believes in proactively protecting your privacy and security to keep you and your family safe. We provide online privacy services including open-source risk assessments, sensitive data removal, social media privacy, disinformation production, as well as open-source due diligence and cyber investigations, education, and consulting.

Contact us to learn more.

Ethos Intelligence
208.718.1588
Info@ethosintelligence.com
www.ethosintelligence.com